

Relationships & People

50 words · Relationships & People

NOUNS

friendship

a close, trusting relationship between people who are not family

Their friendship has lasted over thirty years.

acquaintance

a person you know slightly but who is not a close friend

He's not really a friend, more of an acquaintance.

bond

a deep emotional connection between people

The bond between mother and child is incredibly strong.

chemistry

a natural attraction or emotional connection between two people

There was immediate chemistry between them.

partner

a person you are in a romantic relationship with

She introduced her partner to her parents over dinner.

trust

firm belief in the honesty and reliability of another person

Trust is the foundation of any good relationship.

commitment

a strong dedication to a person or relationship

Marriage requires commitment from both sides.

confidant

a person trusted enough to be told someone's most private thoughts and feelings

Her older sister has always been her confidant, the one she calls first with any news.

ADJECTIVES

close

having a strong emotional bond with someone

She's very close to her sister. They speak every day.

supportive

providing encouragement and emotional help

Her family have been incredibly supportive throughout her illness.

toxic

(of a relationship) harmful, destructive, and emotionally damaging

She finally left the toxic relationship after two years.

estranged

no longer in contact with a family member due to a disagreement

He's been estranged from his father for over a decade.

loyal

faithful and devoted to a person, cause, or relationship

He's been a loyal friend through some very difficult times.

clingy

overly dependent on another person for emotional support or attention

He found her a bit clingy after only two dates.

tight

(of a friendship or group) very close and loyal

They're a really tight group. They do everything together.

platonic

(of a relationship) close and affectionate but not sexual or romantic

They've always had a purely platonic friendship.

unconditional

given or offered without any conditions or limitations

A parent's love should be unconditional.

VERBS

clash

to have a strong disagreement or conflict with someone

She clashed with her manager over the new policy.

rekindle

to revive a relationship or feeling that had faded

They rekindled their friendship after meeting at a school reunion.

PHRASAL VERBS

get on with

to have a friendly relationship with someone

She gets on really well with her colleagues.

fall out

to have a serious argument that damages a relationship

They fell out over money and haven't spoken since.

break up

to end a romantic relationship

They broke up after five years together.

make up

to become friends again after an argument

They made up the next day and pretended nothing had happened.

turn to

to go to someone or something for help, advice, or support

When things get tough, she always turns to her sister.

grow apart

to gradually become less close to someone over time

They didn't argue. They just grew apart.

look up to

to admire and respect someone

She's always looked up to her older brother.

let down

to disappoint someone by failing to do what was expected

He really let her down when he didn't turn up to the wedding.

drift apart

to slowly lose contact with someone without a specific cause

After university, they gradually drifted apart.

settle down

to begin a stable life, often with a long-term partner

We settled down quite young compared to our friends.

confide in

to share personal secrets or worries with someone you trust

She confided in her best friend about the problems at work.

COLLOCATIONS

extended family

the wider circle of relatives beyond parents and children, including grandparents, aunts, uncles and cousins

At Christmas the whole extended family crams into my nan's tiny kitchen.

have a lot in common

to share similar interests, values, or experiences

They have a lot in common. They both love hiking and cooking.

get to know

to spend time learning about someone's personality and character

It takes time to really get to know someone.

long-distance relationship

a romantic partnership between two people who live far apart

They kept a long-distance relationship going for two years before she finally moved over.

IDIOMS

hit it off

to immediately get along well with someone you've just met

They hit it off straight away and talked for hours.

break the ice

to say or do something that relieves tension or shyness when people meet for the first time

She asked about his accent to break the ice at the networking event.

on the rocks

(of a relationship) in serious difficulty

Their marriage has been on the rocks for a while now.

the spitting image of

looking extremely similar to another person, especially a relative

Put a moustache on him and he'd be the spitting image of his grandfather.

thick as thieves

very close friends who share secrets and trust each other completely

Those two have been thick as thieves since primary school.

blood is thicker than water

family relationships are more important than other bonds

He forgave his brother. Blood is thicker than water.

a shoulder to cry on

a person who listens and offers comfort during difficult times

She's always been a shoulder to cry on when things go wrong.

tie the knot

to get married

They're finally tying the knot next summer, after eight years together.

through thick and thin

through good times and bad times

She's been there for me through thick and thin.

the black sheep of the family

someone regarded by their relatives as an outsider or a disappointment compared with the rest of them

Ever since he dropped out of law school to become a chef, he's been the black sheep of the family.

joined at the hip

two people are very close friends or partners and spend almost all their time together

They're joined at the hip, you never see one without the other.

not see eye to eye

to disagree with someone about something

They don't see eye to eye on politics, but they're still close friends.

on the same wavelength

thinking in the same way; understanding each other easily

We've always been on the same wavelength. We barely need to explain things.

SET PHRASES

I see where you're coming from, but...

a polite way to acknowledge someone's opinion before disagreeing

I see where you're coming from, but I think we should wait until she's had time to process it.

MODERN SLANG

bestie

a person's best or closest friend (informal)

She's been my bestie since primary school.

ride or die

a loyal friend or partner who will stick with you through anything, no matter how difficult

She's my ride or die, always the first to show up when I need her.